

ECON 300 – Labour Economics
Winter 2026

Instructor Information	
Instructor	Muhebullah Karimzada
Contact Information	✉ karimzada@unbc.ca ☎ Phone: TBA
Office Location & Hours	10-4522 ⌚ Tue: 2:30 pm – 4:00 pm Thu: 2:30 pm – 4:00 pm or by appointment
Teaching Assistant	✉ TBA

Course Information	
Lectures	<i>Tuesday and Thursday from 1:00 pm to 2:20 pm in Room 5-174</i>
Course Format	In-Person
Course Description	An examination of the Canadian labour market. The course considers labour demand and supply, wages and terms of employment, wage structures and differentials, education and training, unemployment, unions, and selected labour market policies.
Required Text	• <i>Labour Market Economics</i>, 9th edition, by Dwayne Benjamin, Morley Gunderson, Thomas Lemieux, Tammy Schirle, and William Craig Riddell (McGraw-Hill Ryerson, 2021) [BGLSR]
Additional Resources	Additional resources (e.g. lecture slides, practice problem sets) are posted on Moodle. Students are responsible for downloading and saving course material on Moodle before the access to their courses is shut off.

Evaluation & Assessments

Learning in this course results primarily from lectures, in-class discussions, home readings, and practice problem sets. Students learning and progress in this course will be evaluated on individual basis. Grades for this course will be calculated as follows:

Assessment	Weight	Due Date
In-class quizzes	10%	Jan 22 nd , Feb 5 th , Mar 5 th , 26 th , and April 2 nd .
Assignment	15%	March 31 st , 2026
Midterm exam 1	20%	February 12 th , 2026
Midterm exam 2	20%	March 19 th , 2026
Final Exam	35%	TBA
Total	100%	

Course schedule by week

Week	Date	Topic	Evaluation Due Dates
1	Jan 8 th	Ch.1 Introduction to Labor Market Economics	
2	Jan 13 th & 15 th	Ch. 2 Labour Supply: Individual Attachment to the Labour Market	
3	Jan 20 th & 22 nd	Ch. 3 Labour Supply and Public Policy: Work Incentive Effects of Alternative Income Maintenance Programs	Quiz 1: Jan 22 nd , 2026 Ch. 1 - 2
4	Jan 27 th & 29 th	Ch. 5 Demand for Labour in Competitive Labour Markets	
5	Feb 3 rd & 5 th	Ch. 7 Wages and Employment in a Single Labour Market	Quiz 2: Feb 5 th , 2026 Ch. 3 & 5
6	Feb 10 th & 12 th	Ch. 8 Compensating Wage Differentials	Midterm exam 1: Feb 12 th , 2026 Ch. 1 – 3, 5 & 7
	Feb 17 th – Feb 20 th	UNBC Mid-Semester Break	
7 & 8	Feb 24 th – Mar 5 th	Ch. 9 Human Capital Theory: Applications to Education and Training	Quiz 3: Mar 5 th , 2026 Ch. 8
9	Mar 10 th & 12 th	Ch. 11 The Economics of Immigration	
10	Mar 17 th & 19 th	Ch. 12 Discrimination and Male-Female Earnings Differentials	Midterm exam 2: Mar 19 th , 2026 Ch. 8 – 9, & 11
11	Mar 24 th & 26 th	Ch. 16 Unemployment: Meaning, Measurement and Canada's Experience	Quiz 4: Mar 26 th , 2026 Ch. 12
12	Mar 31 st & April 2 nd	Ch. 17 Unemployment Causes and Consequences	Assignment: Mar 31 st Quiz 5: April 2 nd , 2026 Ch. 16
13	April 7 th & 9 th	Final Exam Review	

Please Note:

1. For some chapters selected portions will be covered as a part of the course material.
2. If a student misses a lecture for any reason, it is student's responsibility to obtain class lecture notes and other relevant material.
3. There will be five in-class quizzes, with dates listed in the table above. Each quiz will be held during the last 30 minutes of the lecture. Only your top four scores will be counted, giving you one free pass. A missed quiz will automatically be considered your free pass.
4. There will be no make-up midterms.
5. If a midterm exam is missed, given proper documentation, 50% of the missed midterm weight will be transferred to the other midterm and the remaining 50% of the weight will be allocated to the final exam. Students must write at least one midterm exam.
6. Quizzes, midterms, and the final exam are strictly individual assessments and will be closed book.
7. Quizzes, midterms, and the final exam will feature a mix of question types, including short answer, analytical problems, numerical calculations, mathematical derivations, true/false, multiple choice, and fill-in-the-blank.
8. Your grades on quizzes and midterms will be posted on Moodle. Please immediately report to the instructor any discrepancy between the posted and actual grades.
9. Only the Registrar's Office can issue final grades. Hence, marks for the final exam will not be posted on Moodle.
10. You are encouraged to contact course instructor or course TA for any questions on the course material and outlines, evaluation scheme, and the final exam.

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Use of generative AI is NOT allowed in this course, unless specifically authorized by the instructor. Please consult with the instructor if any clarification is needed. General guidance on the acceptability of using generative AI at UNBC can be found [here](#).

Plagiarism

Plagiarism is a misrepresentation of information that can result in a misattribution of credit, up to and including representing someone else's work as your own. When you incorporate the words, ideas, graphics, or other products from someone else's work into your projects, you must give credit by providing a citation and reference to the source work.

It is your responsibility to:

1. Familiarize yourself with and understand the information on [plagiarism](#) provided by the Academic Success Centre,
2. And the UNBC policy on Student Conduct, plagiarism and other academic offenses, as described in the UNBC Undergraduate calendar.

Grading System - Undergraduate Assessments

Grade Point	Letter Grade	Percentage	Definition/Standing
4.33	A+	90 -100%	Excellent
4.00	A	85-89.9%	
3.67	A-	80-84.9%	
3.33	B+	77-79.9%	Good
3.00	B	73-76.9%	
2.67	B-	70-72.9%	
2.33	C+	67-69.9%	Satisfactory
2.00	C	63-66.9%	
1.67	C-	60-62.9%	Marginal
1.33	D+	57-59.9%	
1.00	D	53-56.9%	
0.67	D-	50-62.9%	
0.00	F	0-49.9%	Failure

Student Services

University students often encounter setbacks from time to time that can impact academic performance. If you experience difficulties and need assistance, it's important to reach out. The following resources are available **free** to all students at UNBC and can help address mental, emotional, or physical health concerns:

General IT & Moodle Support

IT Services can assist you with accessing your UNBC account or Moodle, please email support@unbc.ca or visit their [Support for Students](#) page. If you have specific questions or errors while uploading assignments, using video, Kaltura etc. contact the Centre for Teaching Learning & Technology at ctl@unbc.ca.

Academic Advising

For questions regarding course load, understanding your degree requirements or your GPA please reach out to Academic Advising located in the Enrollment Services Room 7-702.

Webpage: [Student Advising](#)

Phone: 250-960-6306

Email: advising@unbc.ca

The Academic Success Centre (ASC)

The Academic Success Centre provides students with free access to academic support services: Tutoring (by appointment, asynchronous online, or drop-in), personalized study skills assessments and peer-led course supports. ASC services are available in person (room 5-139) at the Prince George Campus and online

Webpage: [Academic Success Centre](#)

Phone: 250-960-6367 | Toll Free 1-888-440-3440

Email: asc@unbc.ca

Access Resource Centre (ARC)

The Access Resource Centre (ARC) provides services to students with documented health conditions and/or disabilities. ARC staff are available to meet with you to determine which academic accommodation can be put in place to support you in achieving their academic goals, provide referrals, and help advocate for you.

Webpage: [Access Resource Centre](#)

Phone: 250-960-5682 | Toll Free 1-888-960-5682

Email: arc@unbc.ca

UNBC Counselling Services

Offers counseling for all students as well as access to First Nations Counseling Services

Offers health and general services that support academic success and personal wellbeing of students

Webpage: [UNBC Counselling Services](#)

Phone: 250-960-6369

Email: wellness@unbc.ca

Crisis Centre for Northern BC (24/7)

If you are feeling overwhelmed, depressed, confused, suicidal, or just needing someone to listen to, the crisis line provides emotional support, suicide intervention and referral information. If you are unable to meet course expectations due to mental health reasons, please discuss your situation with your instructor, counsellor or/and an academic advisor.

Webpage: <https://crisis-centre.ca/>

Phone: Northern BC: [1-888-562-1214](tel:1-888-562-1214) | Youth Support: [1-888-564-8336](tel:1-888-564-8336) | Anywhere in BC: [1-800-784-2433](tel:1-800-784-2433)

UNBC SAFE app

UNBC SAFE features emergency contacts, services, information and safety tips. Emergency messaging can be sent to you via Push notifications when enabled. Download the App [here](#).

UNBC Athletics

Please note that students involved in University Athletics will be required to notify the instructor at least two weeks in advance of any official athletics commitments (e.g., games, travel) that conflict with due dates.

Food Security

We understand the cost of living is higher than ever, and it's hard to learn when you're hungry. The [NUGSS Food Bank](#) (located in the NUGSS office in Building 6) is open to all students.